

Half-battery masterpieces

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Half battery is an arrangement where two pieces of the same colour stand between a friendly linear piece (rook, bishop queen) and the opponent's king, so that moving of either of the intermediate pieces off the line would produce a battery with the remaining piece.

Half battery problems make solving much more difficult in that the solver has to not only spot the correct piece which makes the key but also decide on the destination of the key piece. Here I present here three half-battery two-move masterpieces with varied ideas all published in the same year!

N.G.G.Van Dijk

1 prize, Die Schwalbe 1961



Mate in two moves

The first example above by the Norwegian master is a typical try problem which shows a complete tour by each white knight. Each of the sixteen mates is forced threatening eight mates by its stable companion..

Try 1.Ng3? threat (dN any) 1...Nb6 2.Nxb6; 1...Nc7 2.Nxc7; 1...Qf8/Qe8 2.Ne7; g6 2.Nf6; 1...Bg3 2.Nf4; 1...Bf2 2.Ne3; 1...Bc3 2.Nxc3; 1...Bb4 2.Nxb4 But fails to 1...h6! **Key 1.Nc3!** threat (2.fN any) 1...Nb6 2.Qxb6; 1...Bd2 2.Ne3; 1...Bxc3; 1...Bg3 2.Nxg3; 1...g6 2.Ng7; 1.Qf8 2.Nd6; 1...Qb8 2.Nd6 1...Bh4 2.Nxh4

The second problem below is a splendid zagoruyko exposition of half battery theme. In the set play the position of WNs enable him to meet 1...fxe3 2.Rg4; 1...Rxc2 + 2.Qxc2. Try 1.Nd3? (threat Nxf2) 1...Rxc2+ 2.dNxc2; 1...fxe3 2.Nc6; 1...Kxe3 2.dNc6 but 1...h1Q! Key 1.Nb3! threat 2.Nd2. 1...Rxc2+ 2.bNxc2; 1...fxe3 2.dNc6

L.I.Loshinski & Chepizny

Die Schwalbe 1961



Mate in two moves

The third half battery problem below for solving shows changed mates after star-flights in half-battery.

J.M.Rice, 2 prize

Dutch PS Jubilee Ty 1961



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Try in two-movers': Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Try in two movers': set 1...e1Q 2.Rd4; 1...e1N 2.Be3 Try 1.Ne3? 1...e1Q 2.Qc2; 1...e1N 2.Nf1; 1...Ke1 2.Qxc1; 1...Ba3 2.cNe4 but 1...Bb2! **Key 1.Nf2!** zz 1...e1Q 2.Qd3; 1...e1N 2.fNe4; 1...Ke1 2.Qxc1; 1...Ke3 2.Qs3

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